kidnapping for ransom to foreign funding, to raise finances to run the organisation and to implement its plans. It used all tools of publicity and communication to spread its terror and to propagate its ideology. In the beginning, it had claimed that it came into being as a reaction to the US invasion of Afghanistan, but ultimately took upon itself to impose *Sharia* (Islamic system) in not only FATA but also throughout Pakistan.

The TTP's Swat chapter led by Maulvi Fazlullah was more volatile than its parent organisation as it extended its sway across Swat and brazenly challenged the writ of the government. It ruthlessly bombed schools and beheaded people. Ultimately, the army quelled them and moved them out of their strongholds. However, they could not be eliminated completely.

The TTP's influence in the province of Punjab led to the phenomenon of Punjabi Taliban, who did not have command and control structure like in FATA and Swat but were equally determined and dangerous. They attacked armed forces and their offices and bases.

In this chapter, I have also scrutinised the socio-economic implications of the security situation to see how these terrorists were biting at the roots of the country. The persistent streak of terrorism jolted the government and the people. In addition to the great loss of lives, the economy of the country suffered badly as the foreign investment dwindled and exports diminished. Moreover, the social and psychological impact on the people and the government had been enormous. Fear and mistrust became predominant in society. Lifestyles changed, especially in the urban areas. Barricades and gated residential areas became a common feature in big cities.

People remained confused and perplexed about the real identity of perpetrators. It was hard for them to believe that Pakistanis could be involved in such dreadful terrorist acts in their own country. They sought foreign involvement for coaxing or luring them to indulge in terrorism, as was usually told by the government.

Nevertheless, a few horrific incidents of terrorism and high-handedness of the terrorists enraged people, which enabled the army to take effective action against the Swati TTP. It took many years for the people to become aware of their identity and develop deep dislike for them. The government was held responsible for not exposing the terrorists in an unequivocal manner. The religious parties, especially belonging to the Deobandi sect, like Jamaat-e-Islami and Jamiat Ulema-e Islam, despite knowing the culprits hardly ever condemned them for their